



YOU ARE **32 WEEKS AND 1 DAY**
55 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

In this image, the hands are folded over beneath the chin and there's a foot up by the mouth and nose. It can look as if your baby is quite a contortionist but because they are still quite skinny, the joints allow for a great deal of flexibility.

“If you feel you have little control over your own body, it's natural to think your figure will never be normal again—but it will!”

At this stage, you'll still be gaining about 1–2.2 lb (0.5–1 kg) per week, but weight gain tends to slow down in the last few weeks. By now, your belly will have stretched and your belly button may have popped out—this can be quite [protruding](#) and may be seen through your clothes. You may have developed a linea nigra in your second trimester, a dark line of pigmentation down the center of your abdomen (see [Working during pregnancy](#)).

Like most women, you are probably happy and excited about having a baby but a little concerned about getting your figure back after the birth. Some women get quite upset at the thought that their abdomens may not return to their previous shape after the birth, and this is completely normal. Rest assured that with gentle exercise and the continuation of your healthy diet, your figure can return to its prepregnancy state and your belly button should pop back to its normal shape of its own accord. The key is to remember it will take a bit of time—it did, after all, take nine months to gain the weight.

ASK A DOCTOR

I want to work right up to the birth—is that allowed? Yes. Many women do, so they don't waste any maternity leave before baby. Check with your doctor to make sure it's okay for you. Think carefully before making this decision. Late pregnancy can be extremely tiring and, if your job is mentally and/or physically taxing, it may be better to begin your leave before your due date. You will also need time to prepare for the arrival of your baby.

NUTRITIOUS FIBER

Eating fiber is the most natural way to keep your bowel movements regular, so it will help prevent or relieve constipation—a common problem in the third trimester.

The recommended 25g of fiber per day can be difficult to achieve, but if you base all your meals around fiber-rich whole grains and include legumes such as lentils, beans, and peas, and eat a minimum of five portions of vegetables and fruit a day, you'll be well on your way. Eating fiber